

COMMON SENSE

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Protect Girls Sports

Common sense is not merely a slogan; it is the faculty by which we perceive the plain truths of our existence. In the realm of athletics, a plain truth is currently under siege...

BY MARK GREENSTEIN

Common sense is not merely a slogan; it is the faculty by which we perceive the plain truths of our existence. In the realm of athletics, a plain truth is currently under siege: that biological differences between the sexes matter, and that fairness requires we acknowledge them.

It has been over fifty years since Title IX was enacted. Its purpose was explicit and noble—to ensure that young women had the same opportunities as young men to compete, to strive, and to achieve glory on the playing field. It was a recognition that without distinct categories, female athletes would be effectively erased from the podium. Today, we face a peculiar regress where the very category of 'girls' sports' is being dismantled in the name of a new, abstract definition of inclusion.

We are told that to exclude biological males who identify as females from girls' sports is a form of bigotry. But let us apply the lamp of experience. Sports are discriminative by nature. We discriminate by age—we do not force 12-year-olds to wrestle 18-year-olds. We discriminate by weight in boxing and wrestling—we do not pit the featherweight against the heavyweight. We do this not out of malice, but out of a fierce commitment to fairness. Sex is the most fundamental of these biological categories.

When a biological male competes in female athletics, the competitive balance is shattered. The bone density, muscle mass, and lung capacity conferred by male puberty provide an insurmountable advantage that no amount of training or 'identification' can erase. To ignore this is to tell every girl on the starting line that her effort, her discipline, and her dreams are secondary to the validation of another's personal identity.

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BY MARK STEWART

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